Colossians 1:24–29 — Leader / Learner Guide

Christ in You, the Hope of Glory · a one-page guide for leaders and learners

Christ Is All — A Study of Colossians · TheGospelVault.com · @iJohn.316 (Instagram)

① Big Idea and Context

Big idea: God's long-hidden mystery is now revealed: Christ in you, the hope of glory, and Paul suffers, serves, and labors in Christ's power to present every believer mature.

Paul, "made a minister" of the gospel (1:23), explains his ministry. Against false teachers who prized secret mysteries for an elite, he presents God's mystery for all the saints.

- **The suffering:** afflictions borne for the Church; not a lack in the atonement.
- **The stewardship:** Paul dispenses God's revealed mystery faithfully.
- **The success:** proclaiming Christ to present every believer complete.

② The Mystery Revealed — Three Anchor Verses

Verse	What it says	Teaching point
1:24	*"filling up what is lacking in Christ's afflictions"*	*Thlipsis* = life's afflictions, never the atonement; the Head feels the body's pain.
1:27	*"Christ in you, the hope of glory"*	The mystery is a Person indwelling Jew and Gentile alike.
1:28	*"admonishing every man and teaching every man … present every man complete"*	Maturity for every believer, not an elite.

A mystery is truth unknowable until God reveals it, not a riddle for the clever.

Presentation: linked with the Judgment Seat of Christ, where rewards, not eternal life, are at issue.

③ Teaching Flow

1. **The suffering (1:24)** — For the Colossians, connected to Christ's afflictions, for the Church.
2. **The stewardship (1:25)** — Minister and teacher by a trust from God.
3. **The revelation (1:26)** — Hidden in God for ages; now manifested; four Church mysteries.
4. **The secret (1:27)** — Riches of glory among the Gentiles: Christ in you, the hope of glory.
5. **The success (1:28–29)** — Proclaim, admonish, teach; present every believer mature; labor in His energy.

④ Clarify While Teaching

- **"What is lacking":** never imply Christ's atonement was incomplete.
- **Mystery and the Old Testament:** the study holds (dispensationally) that the Church was not revealed in the OT; others see foreshadowing. The mystery is not Gentile salvation itself (Gen. 12:3).
- **"Hope of glory":** the study takes it as sharing Christ's glory and reward, not as the hope of getting to heaven; many commentators take it more broadly.
- **"Complete" (*teleios*):** maturity, not sinless perfection.

⑤ Discussion and Close

1. Do you live each day aware that Christ lives in you? What difference would that make tomorrow?
2. How can Paul speak of "filling up what is lacking" without denying the finished work of the cross?
3. Why does Paul repeat "every man" three times in verse 28?

Close: Next, Paul shares his struggle for believers he has never seen and urges them to walk in Christ as they received Him (2:1–7). "Christ in you, the hope of glory."

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